

GROUNDWORK — MASTER PLAN

The Homeownership Layer

For: Sameer, Ryan, Armin | July 2026 | CONFIDENTIAL

1. THE VISION

Every product in this market treats the transaction as the product. Find a pro, book a job, done, goodbye. Nobody has built around the truth:

A home is a 30-year relationship. Every product treats it like a one-night stand.

Groundwork's definition: **Every home in America gets a living digital twin.** It remembers everything, predicts what breaks, scores the home's health, negotiates with the neighborhood, and transfers to the next owner. Contractor matching is just the front door.

The ladder we climbed:

- Rung 1: Contractor matching app → a feature
- Rung 2: Homeowner operating system → a product
- Rung 3: The home's permanent memory + brain → a moat
- Rung 4: The layer through which everything about a home flows → a monopoly

One-line pitch: "Tinder gets you the contractor. Groundwork remembers everything they did, tells you what's next, and never lets you get ripped off again."

2. THE FIVE MECHANICS

2.1 The Home Passport

Every home builds a verified, permanent, timestamped record: every project, contractor, dollar, warranty, photo — tamper-evident. **The Passport transfers when the house sells.** Sellers get a more valuable house (Carfax'd homes sell better). Buyers inherit the home's full memory and are onboarded automatically. 6M US home sales/year = 6M built-in acquisition events. *"Carfax for homes — except we also do the repairs."*

2.2 The Home Health Score

Every house gets a 0–100 score that moves with maintenance behavior. Skip HVAC service → drops. Complete roof inspection → rises. Humans cannot ignore a number attached to something they own. Neighbors compare, buyers demand it, sellers flaunt it, insurers eventually pay for it. Retention becomes a game loop.

2.3 The Oracle

Predictive AI that speaks first: "Your water heater is 11 years old. In your ZIP these fail at year 12. Replace planned: ~\$1,400. Replace flooded: ~\$6,000. Want three quotes?" Fed by home age, systems data, regional patterns, and every completed job on the platform. **The data moat compounds daily.** You don't unsubscribe from the thing protecting your house.

2.4 The Neighborhood Nervous System

ZIP communities as collective intelligence: storm-response triggers ("3 roofs on your street replaced this month — free inspection?"), group-rate demand pooling ("7 neighbors need driveway sealing = 30% off"), true local price transparency from verified Graph data. Nobody has aggregated homeowner demand like a union.

2.5 The Financial Layer (Endgame — documented, not built)

Insurance discounts for high Health Scores. Groundwork-backed warranties. Equity intelligence ("these 3 projects raise your appraisal ~\$40k"). The Passport becomes expected at sale the way inspections are. Built on top of verified home data at scale.

3. WHY WE WIN

Mechanic	Copyable?
The Match (compatibility)	In months — it's the wedge, not the moat
The Home Graph	In years — requires accumulated data
Passport transfer network	No — network effect on the housing stock itself
Oracle prediction accuracy	No — requires historical data only we hold

Competitors: Angi (broad marketplace + maintenance + AI flows), Thumbtack ("one app for your home," reminders, home profile), Houzz Pro (pro-side project tools). All strong in pieces. **Nobody has combined compatibility matching + project execution + permanent transferable home memory in one product.** Our positioning: "The market is fragmented. We are the operating system for the home."

4. THE PRODUCT — THREE PILLARS

Pillar 1 — THE MATCH (building now): Conversational onboarding (who are you → ZIP once → estimate or match) → AI estimate → budget (estimate-anchored) → 5 personality questions → 80%+ compatibility gate → swipe/heart/save → real messaging → process checklist (created → estimate → budget → matched → chat → quote → scheduled → in progress → complete → review) → review.

Pillar 2 — THE HOME GRAPH → PASSPORT (Wave 2): My Home dashboard (rooms, systems, install years, timeline), auto-filing of completed projects, Home Team roster by trade, project-to-maintenance loop (every job spawns warranties + reminders + likely-next), seasonal maintenance engine by ZIP + home age. All records Passport-grade from day one: timestamped, hashed, exportable per property.

Pillar 3 — THE BRAIN → ORACLE + SCORE (Wave 3): AI advisor with the user's full Home Graph as context, quote-fairness checker (works on off-platform quotes too — pulls users in), what's-next roadmap, pre-sale readiness report, Health Score v1.

5. EXECUTION — FIVE WAVES

Wave	Scope	Timeline
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1 — The Match	Finish homeowner journey (J2–J6), design pass, founder walkthrough, waitlist live	Now → ~2 weeks
2 — Graph + Passport seed	My Home, auto-filing, Home Team, maintenance loop, verified record format	Weeks 2–4
3 — Score + Oracle	Health Score v1, Oracle v1 (public data first), quote checker	Weeks 4–8
4 — Nervous System	Demand pooling, street insights, storm triggers	Weeks 8–12
5 — Passport transfer + expansion	Transfer at sale, PM multi-door graphs, agent reports, insurance conversations	Post-raise

Rule: nothing jumps Wave 1. The Match ships first — it's the front door to everything.

6. MARKET & FINANCIAL MODEL

The TAM expansion

- **Old market:** 14M renovation events/year. Events end. Episodic revenue, churn by design.
- **New market:** ~145M owner-occupied US homes. Assets persist. Every home needs a passport, a score, and an oracle. **Thesis change expanded TAM ~10x and made revenue recurring instead of episodic.**

Pricing

- Free: AI estimate, limited matching (1 active match / 3 reveals per day), community view, basic My Home
- **Homeowner+ \$20/mo** (\$10/mo permanent at 10 verified referrals): unlimited matching, full Graph/Passport, maintenance reminders, Home Team, unlimited Brain/Oracle, quote checker, Health Score detail, priority matching
- Contractor: free tier (1 lead/week) / \$49/mo unlimited. Free during beta.

The ceiling (internal fuel — see framing rules below)

- 5% of 145M homes = 7.25M subscribers × \$20/mo = **\$145M MRR ≈ \$1.74B/year**
- Even at 5M subscribers: \$100M MRR ≈ \$1.2B/year
- Before contractor subs, referral-tier economics, or any Wave 5 revenue

HOW TO TALK ABOUT THIS NUMBER (all three of us, always)

✗ Never pitch top-down: "if we capture 5% of 145M homes..." — this is the "1% of China" slide and it reads naive.

✓ Always pitch bottom-up: "Every home that completes ONE project gets a Passport, a Score, and an Oracle — and our retention thesis says they don't leave. 6M homes sell yearly and each sale transfers a Passport to a new owner. We don't need 5% of the market. We need one metro, a proven retention curve,

and the transfer loop compounds. The ceiling happens to be 145M homes × \$240/year — but the path is home by home, ZIP by ZIP."

Unit economics (working assumptions, to be validated in beta)

- CAC target: referral-driven, <\$20 blended
- LTV: \$20/mo × multi-year retention (thesis: Graph makes churn structurally low) — even 24-month retention = \$480 LTV
- The \$10 referral tier is a CAC weapon, not lost revenue: 10 verified referrals per discount = we bought 10 users for \$120/year of discount

7. DISTRIBUTION (Armin's playbook)

1. **Waitlist first:** national ZIP-collecting waitlist. Headline mechanic: "10 referrals = \$10/mo for life." Leaderboard + density map.
2. **Density unlock:** ZIP clusters auto-unlock at thresholds (e.g. 150 homeowners + 25 contractors) — "your area is 63% unlocked, invite neighbors" turns geography into a growth game.
3. **Content engine (infinite angles from the thesis):** home health tips by season/ZIP, real cost transparency ("what a kitchen actually costs in 22201"), "what breaks next in your ZIP," before/after stories, contractor horror stories → how the Trust Breakdown prevents them.
4. **The Passport viral loop (structural, Wave 5):** every home sale transfers a Passport = acquisition without spend.
5. **First-neighbor mechanic:** first user in a ZIP gets "You're the first neighbor here 🙌 invite your neighborhood" — every empty community is a recruitment surface.

Armin's metric: waitlist signups by region (feeds the density map AND the investor traction slide).

8. TEAM & OPERATING RULES

Person	Owns
Sameer	Product direction, AI build direction + output verification, design decisions, demo polish, investor prep
Ryan	Supabase/infra + credentials, technical review, repo/GitHub migration, co-pitch
Armin	Waitlist growth, content, outreach, video, demand-signal reporting (weekly numbers)
Warp (AI)	All build execution under evidence protocol

Standing rules:

1. No work counts as done without evidence: commit hash + real command output.
2. Anything touching money, auth, RLS, or deletion gets human review before merge.
3. Every new table: is_demo column + RESTRICTIVE RLS + purge coverage (WARP.md §14).

- 4. Every artifact traceable to project → property — no orphan data (§15, Passport-grade records).
- 5. Weekly 30-min sync, all three. This document is the single source of truth; changes require agreement in writing.

9. CURRENT STATUS (honest scoreboard, July 2026)

Done and verified: live DB with 21 migrations, demo marketplace seeded (40 homeowners / 25 contractors / projects / matches / reviews), demo isolation with tested RLS walls, 108/108 core tests + 6/6 live security tests, founder demo mode, subscription model implemented, conversational onboarding (J1), properties architecture (J1b), contractor profiles + saved contractors (J5), budget step (J2a), Warm Copper design tokens.

In progress: 5 personality questions (written, founder review pending), J3 swipe / J8 saved list / J4 messaging / J9 ZIP communities / J7 checklist / J6 demo seed, design pass.

Blocked: estimate E2E on Anthropic API key (Ryan — #1 blocker). Waitlist deploy gated on founder approval of the page.

Known risks: repo lives locally (GitHub migration this week), no DB backups on free tier (bundle backups running), attorney ToS review required before any real payments, CodeRabbit auth pending.

10. NEXT 7 DAYS

Day	Focus
1	API key → estimate E2E green. Approve 5 questions. Thesis docs into repo. Kill list execution.
2	J3/J8/J4 verified in browser. Design pass begins. GitHub migration with Ryan.
3	J9/J7/J6 verified. Founder full-journey walkthrough #2. Fix list from walkthrough.
4	Design polish to "simple but expensive." Waitlist page final review.
5	Waitlist DEPLOYED to real domain. Armin gets URL + brief. Marketing begins.
6	Demo script drafted (10-min investor walkthrough). Traction slide skeleton.
7	Team sync: retro, Wave 2 kickoff decision, investor outreach list.

11. FINAL WORD

We are not building an app. We are building the layer the American home runs on. The Match gets them in. The Graph makes leaving unthinkable. The Oracle makes us indispensable. The Passport makes every home sale our salesman. Ship Wave 1. Everything follows.